

EXPLORING THE WORLD

1. A SUNSET WITH BEDOUINS IN THE MOROCCAN SAHARA DESERT
2. BUM LA PASS, ARUNACHAL PRADESH, WHERE, CHITTILAPILLY SAYS, THE JOURNEY IS MORE EXCITING THAN THE DESTINATION
3. DAISY CHITTILAPILLY AT LAKE BLED IN SLOVENIA
4. THE SERENE BEAUTY OF ALASKA. CHITTILAPILLY SAYS SETTINGS LIKE THESE REMIND HER OF THE POWER OF SILENCE AND REFLECTION

During her trek to Machu Picchu, Chittilapilly met a 75-year-old gentleman, and a lady with serious injuries, who were also determined to finish the trek. “This is what I love most about traveling—you always get inspired by the people around you to push yourself further than you thought was possible,” she says. “When we live in metro cities, we tend to meet like-minded people, but when you travel, you meet people from all walks of life who can open your mind to new experiences, and help

you embrace the unknown and the unfamiliar.”

Apart from Peru, Chittilapilly also likes exploring European countries, where she was fascinated by the Villa del Balbianello on the banks of Lake Como in Italy. She says she is yet to find something she doesn’t like in Italy! “If I had to pick a continent, it’s Europe. And if I had to pick a country, then it’s Peru.”

Chittilapilly says that she draws a line in the sand and treats a vacation as a vacation, which helps her reboot and recharge. Not only that, it’s also an opportunity for her to visit new places, immerse herself in the history, art, culture and nature of the place, which she feels enhances her perspective. “I also feel it forms your response to situations and your ability to engage in life broadly, but also at work. It shapes you as a person, a leader and a professional. It broadens your horizons, and you do end up learning, whether consciously or unconsciously.”

So ask her what’s next on her itinerary? Pat comes her reply, “Exploring Antarctica”. **BT**

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